

Issam Seghir

عصام صغير

Software engineer and SaaS founder in Algiers. I design and build products from the first sketch to launch day.

> «كن عصامياً، ولا تكن عظامياً»
>
> Be self-made like ʿIṣām, not proud of your ancestors' bones. Arab proverb, in al-Maydānī's Majmaʿ al-Amṯāl

Drawing	Module
Brand book	1d = 6.4u
Drawn	Repo
2026-10-20	docs/product

The name: a word for the self-made

This is a personal brand, so the name is fixed: it's yours. What the brand does is choose which of its meanings to stand on. In Arabic, ʿIṣām is the man the word عصامي comes from, the everyday word for someone who made himself without inherited rank. For a self-taught engineer who founded his own products, the meaning is already the pitch.

Arabic	عِصام صغير
Latin	**Issam Seghir**
Say it	ee-SAAM se-GHEER (gh as the French r)
Root	ع ص م: to hold fast, to protect
The word	العِصام: the tie of a water-skin, and the strap it is carried by (Lane's Lexicon, citing al-Ṣiḥāḥ, al-Miṣbāḥ, Tāj al-ʿArūs)
Derived	عِصامي: self-made, after ʿIṣām ibn Shahbar
Short form	issam, lowercase, in the mark and the domain

The spelling. "Issam" doubles the s to keep the Arabic ص sharp and short-vowelled in French and English, the convention across the Maghreb. "Seghir" is the Algerian civil-register spelling of صغير, rather than Saghir or Sghir. Both match the GitHub handle `issam-seghir`, so the name is spelled one way everywhere.

Addresses (registry RDAP lookups on 20 October 2026; trademarks not checked):

Domain	Use	State
issam.tech	main	yours Live on Vercel; www redirects here.
issamseghir.com	optional redirect	free Worth holding so the full name also reaches you.
issam.dev	none	someone else's Registered 2026-09-08. Never print it.

In the classical sources

All quotations are from al-Maydānī's *Majmaʿ al-Amthāl*, proverb no. 4189 (vol. 2, p. 331), as printed in the al-Maktaba al-Shāmila edition.

نَفْسُ عِصَامٍ سَوَّدَتْ عِصَاماً

ʿIṣām's own spirit made ʿIṣām a chief.

The proverb itself. Al-Maydānī: «إنه قيل: عصام بن شهبر حاجبُ النعمان بن المنذر», said to be ʿIṣām ibn Shahbar, chamberlain to the king al-Nuʿmān ibn al-Mundhir.

كن عصامياً، ولاَ تكن عظامياً

Be ʿiṣāmī, self-made, and not ʿiẓāmī, someone who boasts of ancestors who are now only bones.

Quoted in the same entry: «وفي المثل».

فإنِّي لاَ أَلُومُكَ في دُخُول ... وَلَكِنْ مَا وَرَاءَكَ يا عِصَامُ؟

I don't blame you for barring the door; but what news is behind you, ʿIṣām?

Al-Nābigha al-Dhubyānī, to ʿIṣām when he kept the poet from the sick king's door. Quoted in the same entry. ʿIṣām was the keeper of a door, which is where the mark comes from.

يضرب في نَبَاهة الرجل من غير قديم ... يعنى أنه خرج بنفسه من غير أولية كانت له

Said of a man who becomes distinguished without an old lineage: he rose by himself, with no inherited start.

Al-Maydānī's explanation of when the proverb is used.

نَفْسُ عِصَامٍ سَوَّدَتْ عِصَامَا … وَعَلَّمَتْهُ الكَرَّ وَالإِقْدَامَا

ʿIṣām's spirit made ʿIṣām a chief, and taught him to charge and press forward.

Given by al-Maydānī with «وقيل» ("and it was said"), without a poet's name; later anthologies attribute it to al-Nābigha.

The Shāmila text prints this line with misplaced vowels (نَفَسُ … سَوْدَتْ عَصَامَا); they are normalised here. Check against a printed edition before using it in print.

Why it works

It's a person

Clients hiring a freelancer hire a person, not a studio. Using your own name keeps the promise personal and accountable.

Self-made is in the word

Arabic speakers already know عصامي. You taught yourself and founded your own products, so the name tells the story before the About page does.

The keeper of the door

ʿIṣām ibn Shahbar kept a king's door. The portfolio is the door to your work, and the mark is drawn as that doorway.

To hold fast

The root means to hold and protect, and the ʿiṣām is the strap that carries the water. Carrying a project safely to launch is the job.

The dot

The saffron square is the dot of the i, a full stop and a text cursor. It marks things that are finished, like a shipped product.

Two scripts, one name

It reads naturally in Arabic and in Latin letters, it's short, and it needs no "studio" or "labs" added to it.

The mark: a doorway with "is" inside

Everything is measured in the dot (d), the saffron square. The doorway is 10d wide; its straight jambs rise 7d to the spring line and the arch rises 6d more, so the opening is taller than a half-circle, the way a door should be. The letters are drawn with a 1d stroke and sit 2d from each jamb. Use "Show construction" in the header to see the measurements.

Spec	Value
Module	d = the dot = the letter stroke = 1/10 of the span (6.4 units in the 72 × 90 viewBox)
Doorway	10d wide, 13d tall: 7d jambs and a 6d arch
Letters	Lowercase i and s, round caps, x-height 4d, set 2d in from each jamb
Clear space	2d on every side
Smallest size	16px tall (favicon). Below 24px the letters may blur, but the arch still reads.
Reading direction	Drawn i then s, left to right, as the "Draw the mark" button shows



Default. Zellige on limewash.



Inverse. Limewash on zellige, for social avatars.



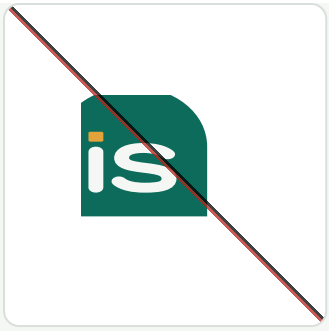
Dark mode. Light zellige on night.



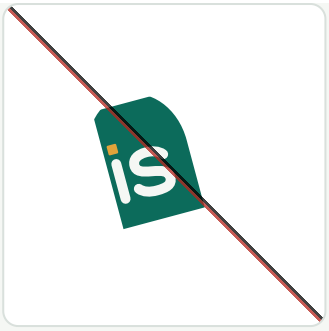
One colour. Letters cut out, for stamps and engraving.



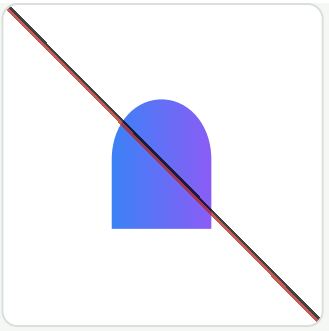
Never



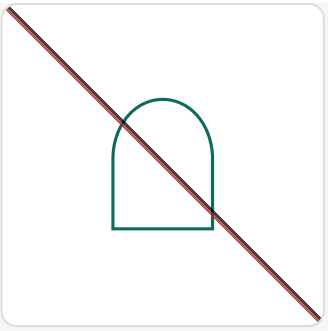
Stretch or squash it



Rotate or tilt it



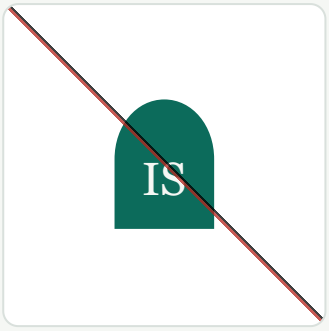
Fill it with a gradient or another hue



Use it as an outline



Place it on a busy photo or pattern without a plain plate



Swap the drawn letters for a font

Lockups

The mark sits where reading starts: on the left of the Latin name and on the right of the Arabic one. The gap between mark and name is 2d. The stacked version is for business cards, slides and the OG image.



Latin, left to right



Arabic, right to left



Stacked

Colour

Taken from Algiers: limewashed walls, glazed zellige tile, saffron, and the blue of the bay. Each token has a light and a dark value. Click a hex code to copy it. Contrast is WCAG 2.2, measured against that theme's page ground.

Limewash / Night

`#F5F7F4` `#0B1620`

`--background`. The page ground in each theme.

Ink

`#10202E` `#E8EEEC`

`--foreground`. Text and headings. 15.4:1 light, 15.5:1 dark.

Stone

`#55636B` `#9AA9AE`

`--muted-foreground`. Secondary text and captions. 5.8:1 light, 7.5:1 dark.

Zellige

`#0C6B5B` `#46BFA3`

`--primary`. The only brand colour: the mark, buttons, links, focus. 6.0:1 light, 8.0:1 dark; text on it 6.0:1 and 8.0:1.

Saffron

`#E2A33A` `#F0B44C`

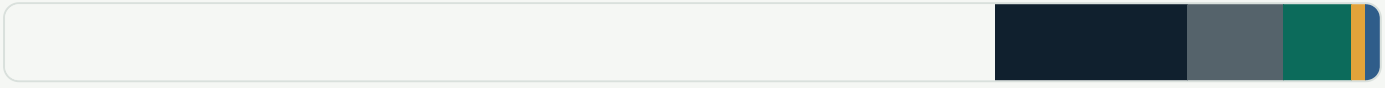
`--highlight`. The dot, availability status and Featured badges. A fill only, never text on the page; ink on it 7.5:1, night on it 9.9:1.

Casbah blue

`#2F5D8A` `#7FA8D6`

`--info`. Links inside long text and informational notes. 6.4:1 light, 7.4:1 dark.

On a typical screen



Limewash 72% · Ink 14% · Stone 7% · Zellige 5% · Saffron 1% · Casbah blue 1%

Typography

Two families drawn for Arabic and Latin together, so both languages share one voice, plus a monospace for code. All three are free on Google Fonts and load through `next/font`.

Reem Kufi

Display, headings and the wordmark. Weights 600–700.

A geometric Kufic design, from the grid-built script family the brand comes from.

I build products people use

أبني منتجات يستخدمها الناس

Readex Pro

Interface and body text in both scripts. Weights 300–500.

16px / 1.6 in Latin, about 17px / 1.8 in Arabic, at most 66 characters a line.

Ecomenia handles orders, delivery, inventory and teams for sellers who run several stores. I led its architecture as CTO.

تدير إيكومينيا الطلبات والتوصيل والمخزون والفرق للبائعين الذين يديرون عدة متاجر. قدت تصميم بنيتها التقنية بصفتي المدير التقني.

JetBrains Mono

Code blocks, commands, and measurements on drawings like this one. Never for labels or headings.

```
pnpm db:generate && pnpm db:migrate
```

Rules: no letter-spacing on Arabic, since it breaks the joins. No italic Arabic.
Sentence case for every label; no tracked-out capitals.

Voice

Plain and specific: say what you built, for whom, and what changed, and let clients supply the adjectives. Write the Arabic directly rather than translating it word for word.

Say	Not
I built the storefront and admin for a shopping platform used by more than 3 million people. بنيت واجهة المتجر ولوحة الإدارة لمنصة تسوّق يستخدمها أكثر من 3 ملايين شخص.	I craft stunning, pixel-perfect digital experiences.
Tell me what you're building. أخبرني بما تبنيه.	Let's build something amazing!
Taking new projects from December. أستقبل مشاريع جديدة ابتداءً من ديسمبر.	🚀 Open to exciting opportunities!
This page didn't load. Try again, or email me. لم تُحمَّل الصفحة. أعد المحاولة، أو راسلني عبر البريد.	Oops! Something went wrong 😢

In use

Issam Seghir

issam.tech

IssamSeghir

Projects About

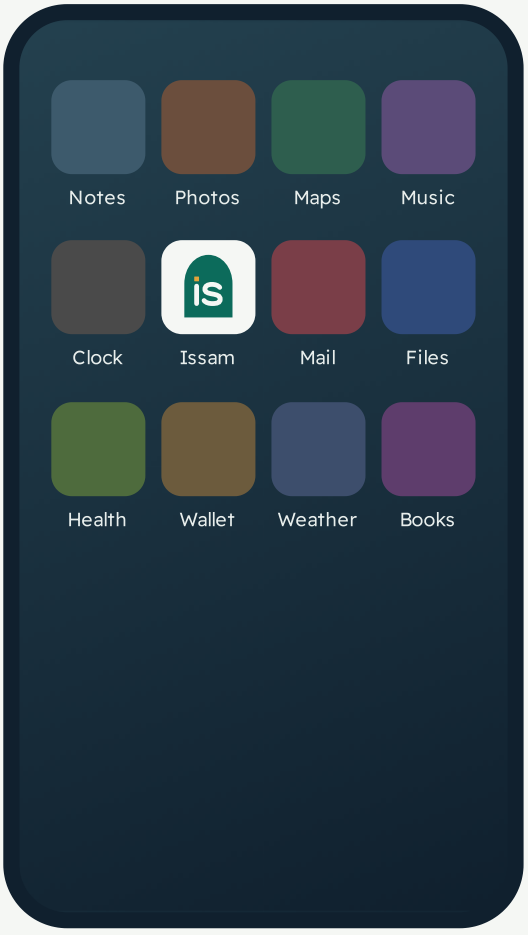
Start a project

Taking new projects

Issam Seghir

عصام صغير

I design and build SaaS products, web platforms and mobile apps, from the first sketch to launch day.



Issam Seghir

Software engineer and SaaS founder

عصام صغير

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Source of truth

- Rules and reasons: `docs/product/brand.md`. This book: `docs/product/brand-book.md`, with files in `docs/product/brand-kit/`
- Mark: `src/components/ui/logo.tsx` (follows the theme), `public/images/brand/logo-mark.svg`, `public/favicon.svg`
- Colour tokens: `src/styles/globals.css` (`:root` and `.dark`). Fonts: `src/app/[locale]/layout.tsx`

History: a stock gold "IS" shield template until October 2026; a grid-built monogram, sketched and rejected on 20 October 2026; the doorway, chosen the same day.

Limits: trademarks not checked. The verse vowels are normalised from a digital edition; check them against a printed copy before print. A designer's review of the mark is welcome before signage or print runs.